HOW MUCH BITCOIN TO RETIRE?

A worked example for retiring in 10 to 20 years.

Start with the spending our investments need to cover. Then compare what different Bitcoin prices would mean for that target.

$3,000
Monthly spending gap in today's money

10 / 20
Years until retirement

$500k-$2m
Illustrative BTC prices at retirement

This is a scenario worksheet, not a Bitcoin price forecast or a guaranteed retirement plan. It assumes converting Bitcoin into a mix of retirement investments when we retire.



Bitcoin Jae
@bitcoin.daily

THE EXAMPLE FROM THE VIDEO

START WITH THE SPENDING GAP

Suppose investments need to cover **$3,000 a month in today's purchasing power**, after pensions, benefits or other retirement income. Include taxes on retirement withdrawals in this spending budget.

STEP	CALCULATION	RESULT
Monthly gap to yearly gap	$3,000 × 12	$36,000
Today's savings target	$36,000 / 3%	$1,200,000
10-year target	$1,200,000 × 1.03^10	$1,612,700
20-year target	$1,200,000 × 1.03^20	$2,167,333

We use **3% as an illustrative first-year withdrawal input** for a retirement portfolio spread across investments. It is not a tested safe withdrawal rate for Bitcoin. It is not a promise that any portfolio will last.

We also assume **3% annual inflation before retirement**. The spending need rises to about $48,381 a year in 2036 or $65,020 in 2046. These are future dollar amounts with the same assumed buying power as $36,000 today.

Ten and twenty years mean how long until retirement. They do not mean how long the retirement portfolio needs to last.

RETIRE IN 10 YEARS | 2036

THE 10-YEAR TABLE

Find the monthly gap in today's money. Compare the gross BTC value needed at each hypothetical price in 2036.

MONTHLY GAP TODAY	YEARLY GAP IN 2036	TARGET IN 2036	BTC AT $500K	BTC AT $1M	BTC AT $2M
$1,000	$16,127	$537,567	1.075	0.538	0.269
$2,000	$32,254	$1,075,133	2.150	1.075	0.538
$3,000	$48,381	$1,612,700	3.225	1.613	0.806
$5,000	$80,635	$2,687,833	5.376	2.688	1.344
$8,000	$129,016	$4,300,532	8.601	4.301	2.150

For the video's $3,000 monthly example, a $1 million Bitcoin would imply **about 1.613 BTC** before taxes and fees on selling it. The video rounds that to about 1.6 BTC.

At $500,000 a coin, the same target needs about **3.225 BTC**. At $2 million a coin, it needs about **0.806 BTC**. The retirement spending goal has not changed; the assumed conversion price has.

All rows assume 3% annual inflation and the same illustrative 3% first-year portfolio withdrawal input. Figures are rounded scenario equivalents, not minimum purchase recommendations. Bitcoin may never reach these prices.

RETIRE IN 20 YEARS | 2046

THE 20-YEAR TABLE

With twenty years of assumed inflation, the same spending goal needs a larger future dollar target. These prices are hypothetical values at retirement, not price predictions.

MONTHLY GAP TODAY	YEARLY GAP IN 2046	TARGET IN 2046	BTC AT $500K	BTC AT $1M	BTC AT $2M
$1,000	$21,673	$722,444	1.445	0.722	0.361
$2,000	$43,347	$1,444,889	2.890	1.445	0.722
$3,000	$65,020	$2,167,333	4.335	2.167	1.084
$5,000	$108,367	$3,612,222	7.224	3.612	1.806
$8,000	$173,387	$5,779,556	11.559	5.780	2.890

For the $3,000 monthly example, a $1 million Bitcoin would imply **about 2.167 BTC** before taxes and fees on selling it. The video rounds that to about 2.2 BTC.

At $500,000 a coin, the same target needs about **4.335 BTC**. At $2 million a coin, it needs about **1.084 BTC**.

Holding 2.2 BTC does not guarantee retirement. The price at conversion, spending, taxes and the retirement plan still determine what it can fund.

As on the 10-year table, the monthly gap includes any taxes on retirement withdrawals. Taxes and fees from the separate sale of BTC are excluded and would increase the gross BTC needed.

USE THE WORKSHEET

PUT OUR OWN NUMBERS IN

INPUT	FILL IN
Monthly spending in today's money, including withdrawal taxes	$_____
Less other monthly retirement income in today's money	$_____
Monthly gap to fund from investments	$_____
Years until retirement	_____ years
Illustrative annual inflation	_____ %
Illustrative first-year portfolio withdrawal rate	_____ %
Assumed BTC price when converting to retirement savings	$_____

Future target = monthly gap x 12 x (1 + inflation)^years / withdrawal rate. Enter percentage inputs as decimals, such as 0.03 for 3%.

Gross BTC equivalent before sale costs = future target / assumed Bitcoin price. Compare more than one price rather than treating the highest one as the plan.

We can also change the withdrawal input. For the $3,000 gap before inflation, 2% implies a $1.8 million target, 3% implies $1.2 million and 4% implies $900,000. This is arithmetic sensitivity, not evidence that a higher rate is sustainable.

If the spending gap is zero, this example does not require Bitcoin to fund that gap. It does not mean emergencies or other financial needs disappear.

WHAT THE EXAMPLE LEAVES OUT

THE TABLE IS A STARTING POINT

Taxes and fees on selling Bitcoin. The tables assume the full gross BTC value can become retirement savings. A sale can produce a tax bill, depending on location, cost basis and other facts. No universal tax rate is assumed. Positive sale costs mean a larger gross BTC value is needed.

The years spent retired. We have not run a longevity model, a sequence-of-returns simulation or a probability-of-success calculation. Retirement duration, portfolio allocation, returns and ongoing fees can materially change the plan.

Changing expenses. Housing, healthcare, dependents, emergencies and taxes can change the spending gap. The fixed inflation assumption will not match every household's experience.

A different Bitcoin outcome. None of the three prices is a forecast. A lower price means more BTC would be needed under this model. A major loss could leave the target unfunded.

The video assumes converting Bitcoin at retirement into a mix of investments. We are not claiming that a Bitcoin-only portfolio can safely pay a fixed income forever.

Educational scenarios only. The worksheet does not select an investment allocation or a withdrawal policy for an individual.

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SOURCES AND CALCULATION NOTES

THE ASSUMPTIONS BEHIND IT

All retirement tables are original arithmetic. The monthly gaps, 3% inflation, 3% withdrawal input and $500k / $1m / $2m BTC prices are stated example inputs. They are not estimates taken from a price model.

Morningstar's retirement-income research studies diversified portfolios with explicit retirement horizons and success criteria. It does not validate a Bitcoin-only withdrawal rule. Our 3% input is a separate illustration, not their published headline result.

Investor.gov explains inflation risk, asset allocation, diversification and crypto-asset risks. These sources support the planning context. They do not endorse the hypothetical prices or establish a probability that these targets will be reached.

Calculations use unrounded inputs. Dollar values are rounded to the nearest dollar and BTC equivalents to three decimal places. The video uses fewer decimal places for readability.

Prepared November 6, 2026. The 2036 and 2046 labels use ten and twenty years from this edition. No current Bitcoin price or personal purchase cost is needed for this scenario calculation.

Morningstar retirement-income research

Investor.gov | Inflation and risk

Investor.gov | Asset allocation

Investor.gov | Crypto assets